

A black and white photograph of a forest floor. Sunlight streams through the dense canopy of trees, creating a dramatic play of light and shadow on the ground covered in fallen leaves and twigs. The trees are mostly bare, suggesting a late autumn or winter setting. The light rays are clearly visible, creating a sense of depth and atmosphere.

LIGHT ON THE LAND
The Sea Ranch

Arthur Drooker

STATEMENT

In the early 60s a developer acquired land from a sheep rancher on the Northern California coast, then assembled a team of architects to design The Sea Ranch—a planned community compatible with the environment. A tenet of the team’s design philosophy was to live “light on the land.”

Flash forward 60 years. While hiking a trail at The Sea Ranch, I saw shafts of sunlight boring through a tangle of tree branches, forming a pool of light on the ground. The sight was so powerful, even sacred, that it stopped me in my tracks. At that moment, “light on the land” took on a deeper meaning. I returned the next day to the same spot, at the same time, and made the photograph that appears on the title slide of this presentation.

Thus began Light on the Land, a series in progress. It represents a new and unexpected direction in my photography. Being city-bred, I was accustomed to working in the built environment, not in nature. But the more time I spent at The Sea Ranch, the more its untamed beauty enthralled me, from sculptural rock formations chiseled by the elements to the soaring embrace of a fairy circle of redwoods. Discovering these wonders reconnected me to nature, providing not just new subject matter to photograph but also a much needed escape from the pandemic.

The images presented here take you on a visual hike through The Sea Ranch. May you see, as I do, the light on the land.

ARTHUR DROOKER

LIGHT THE WAY



OFFERINGS





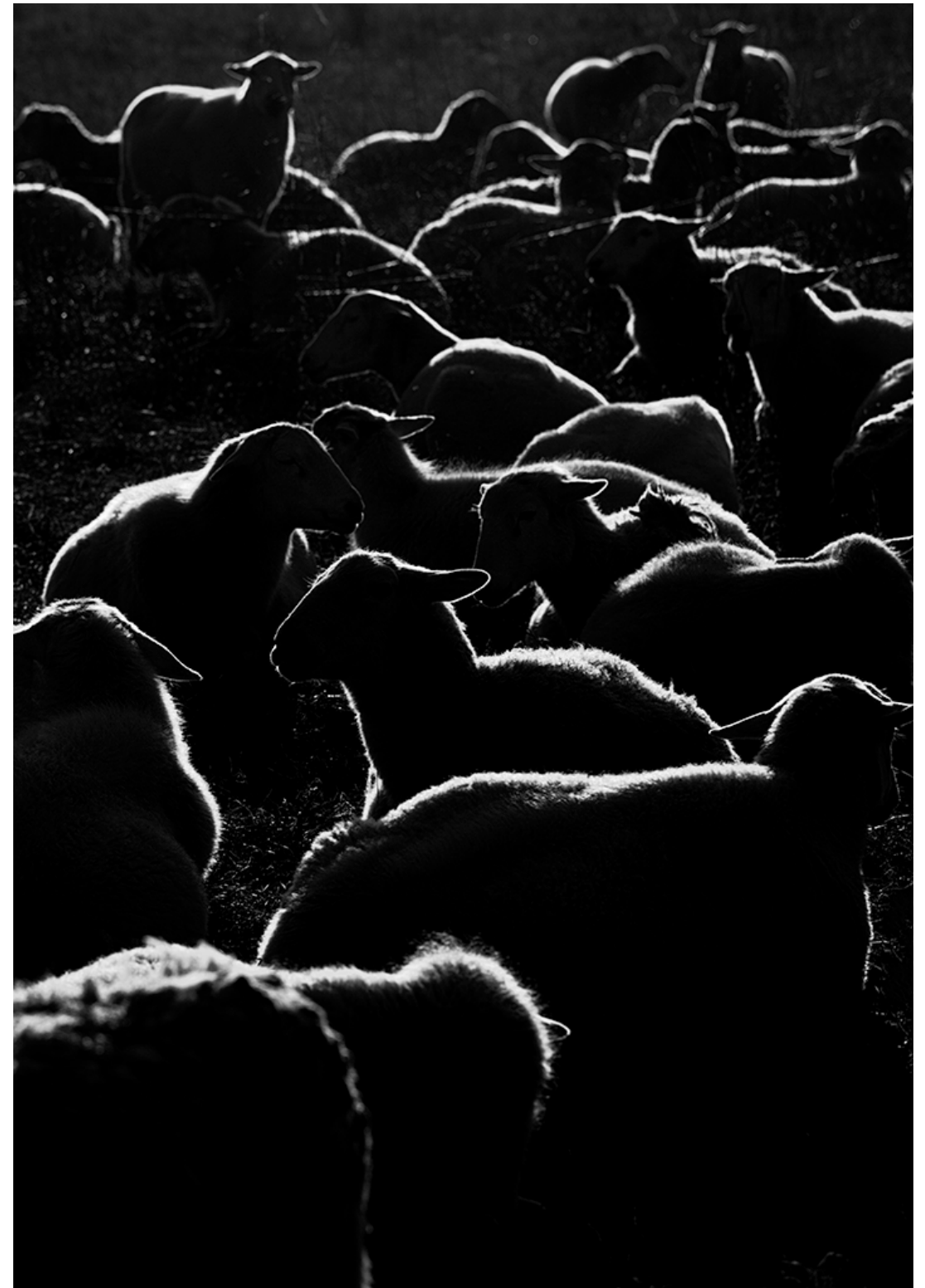
BARN



BARN INTERIOR

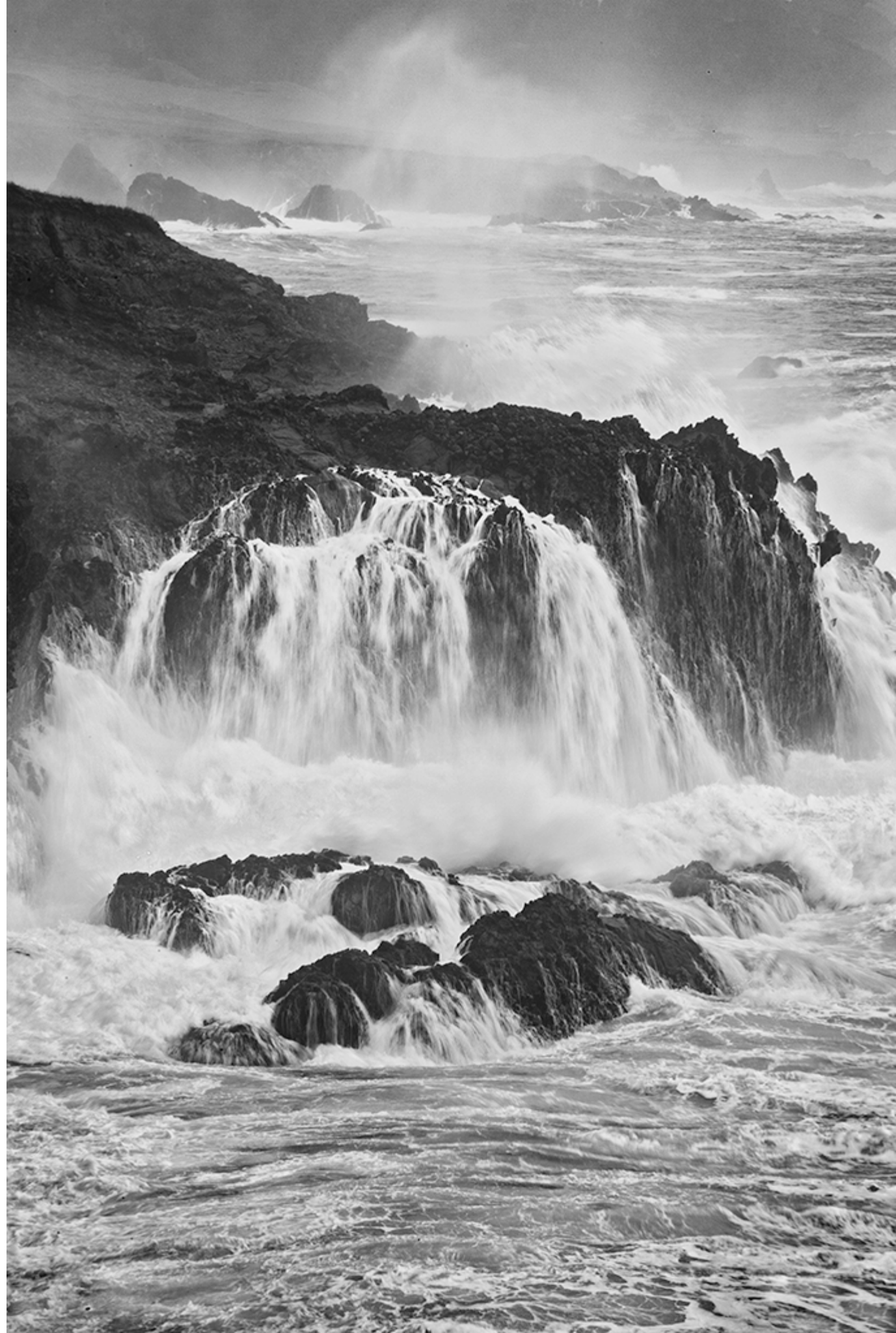


FLOCK TO THE SUN



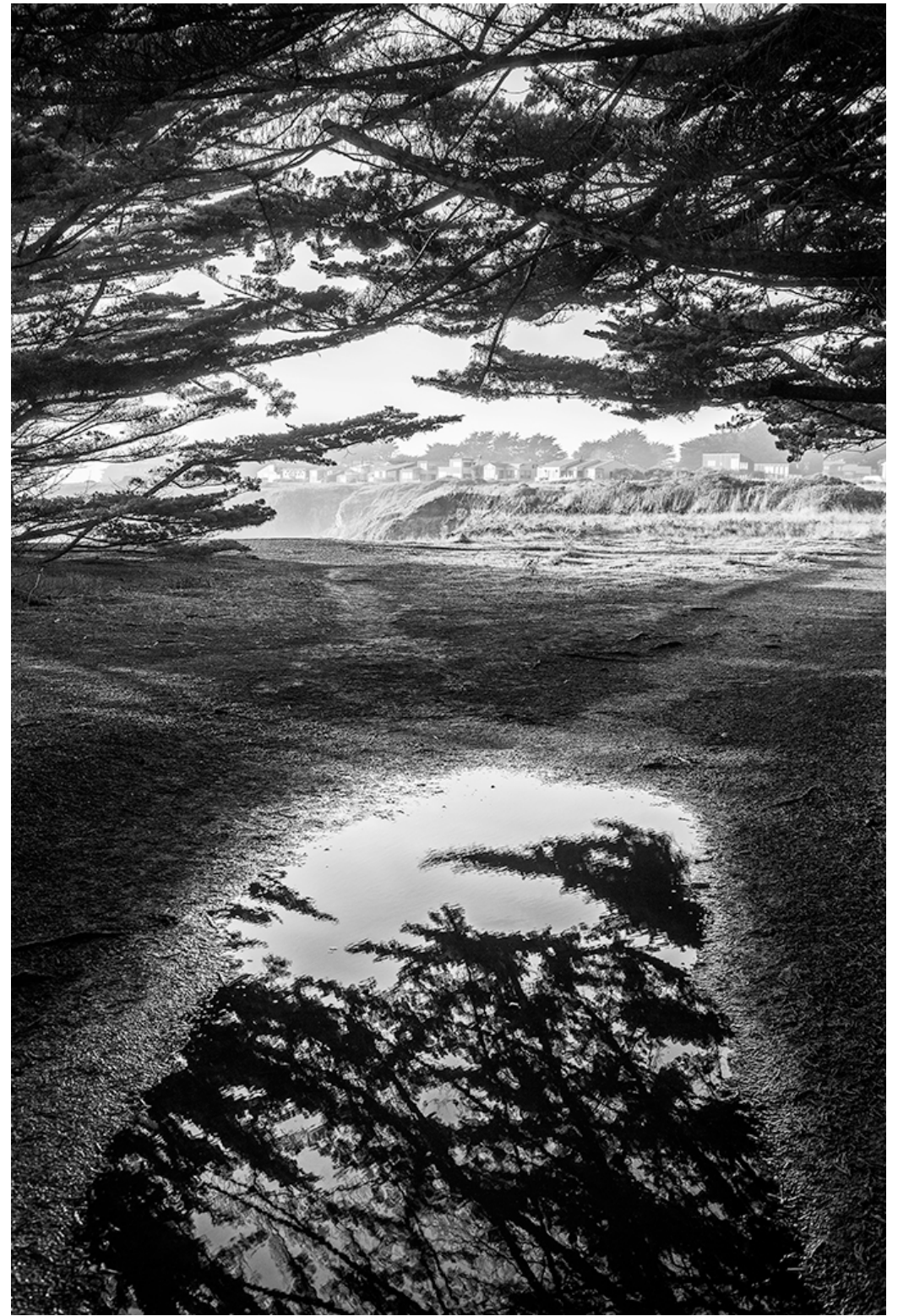
BLACK SHEEP

CRASH. WASH. REPEAT.





RIPPLE EFFECT



PUDDLE TO PONDER

HEDGEROW





TREE OF LIGHT

IN THE FAIRY CIRCLE



BEACH STAIRS



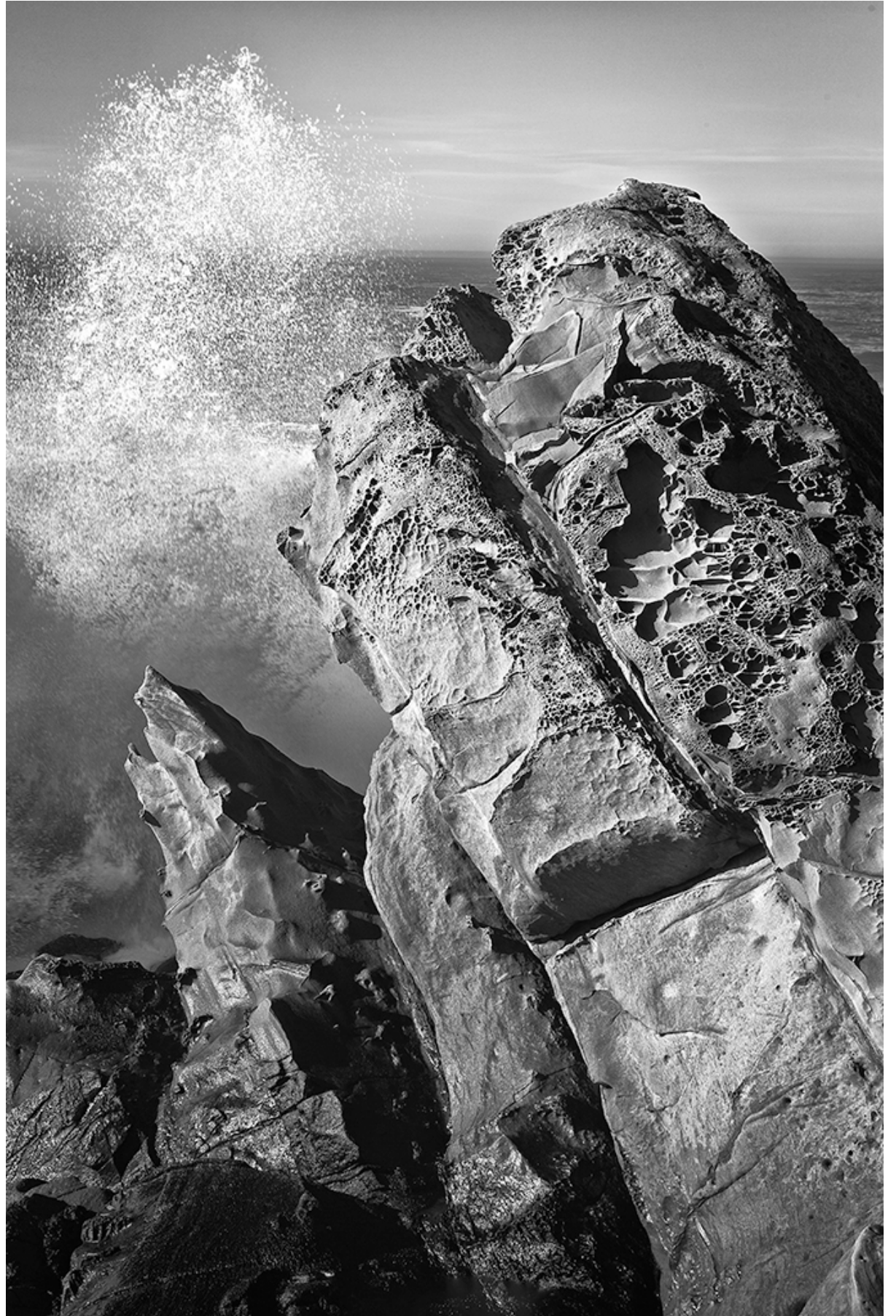


BEACHFRONT PROPERTY

DRIFTWORLD



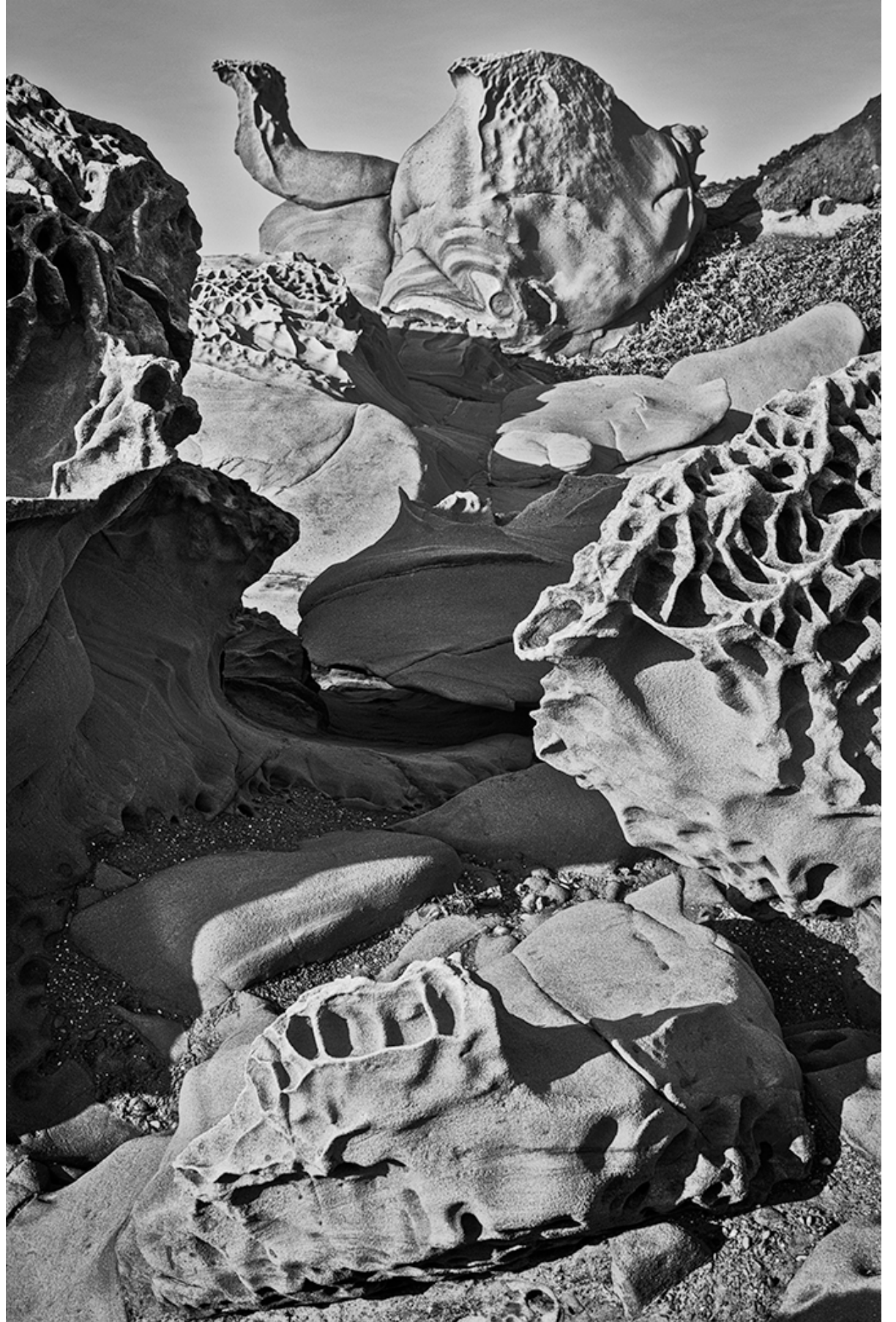
BREACH





GUARDIANS

CAMEL ROCK



TIDE





LAPS



REC ANGLES

HOME





Arthur Drooker is the author and photographer of *American Ruins* (Merrell, 2007), *Lost Worlds: Ruins of the Americas* (ACC, 2011), *Pie Town Revisited* (UNM Press, 2015), *Conventional Wisdom* (Glitterati, 2016), and *City Hall* (Schiffer, 2021). His work has been the subject of a feature story on *CBS Sunday Morning* and has been exhibited widely, including shows at the Virginia Center for Architecture and the Art Museum of the Americas in Washington, DC. A native New Yorker, Drooker resides in Mill Valley, California.

arthurdrooker.com

(323) 270-8784

arthurdrooker@gmail.com

© 2021 Arthur Drooker All rights reserved